



Cambridge IGCSE™

FIRST LANGUAGE ENGLISH

0500/21

Paper 2 Directed Writing and Composition

October/November 2022

INSERT

2 hours

INFORMATION

- This insert contains the reading texts
- You may annotate this insert and use the blank pages for planning. **Do not write your answers** on the insert.



This document has 4 pages. Any blank pages are indicated.

Read **both** texts, and then answer **Question 1** on the question paper.

Text A: Finding the perfect gift

This article was written by a manager of a successful chain of shops.

Gift-giving is an important part of human interaction. It has been documented throughout human history, across all cultures as a unique pastime that has helped to define relationships and strengthen bonds between family, friends, workers and many more groups.

Most people expect to receive a quite high standard of gift, which can put pressure on the individual who gives the present. Every gift has to be better than the last. 5

There is an enormous sense of satisfaction when seeing the joyful expression on the face of someone you've given a gift to, and gift-giving really comes into play when you're missing someone or working away from home. Now, it's a lot easier to order a gift online and send it. It can be a replacement for not being there with the person. The right gift brings a little bit of happiness. 10

Coming up with creative gift ideas is somewhat of an art form. And just like any other type of art, some of us just aren't that good at it. But if you want to avoid the dreaded silence that comes after someone opens the worst gift ever – your gift – put in a little extra time and effort. Purchasing practical, quality gifts that the person will actually use and will last a lifetime.

The gift of a carefully chosen ornament displayed in the home for many years can be a source of happiness to both giver and receiver. 15

Vintage gift ideas are very popular at the moment – unique and much sought-after items to be treasured. Who doesn't want a gift that will hold, or even increase its value – a piece of antique jewellery, a stylish photo frame perhaps?

Saving money and reducing packaging waste by making your own gifts such as baked goods in reusable containers, homemade soaps or homemade jewellery. Instead of buying cards, either make your own using recycled paper or send an e-card. There are lots of great websites where you can make personalised, animated or traditional cards sent right to your friends' and family's inbox. 20

And if you're unlucky enough to have gift givers who often get it wrong, why not host a gift-swapping party with friends, family, or colleagues? It's a great way to find a home for your unwanted gifts. 25

Text B: Experience days and gift experiences

This online blog was written by the owner of a company which sells gift vouchers for experience days and activities.

Things no longer matter. Experiences do.

Why? Because in the modern day, the need to own things is disappearing. We don't need DVDs, CDs or vinyl records any more because we all have subscriptions to streaming platforms for music, film and TV. We don't need photo albums, calendars or books because everything exists in environmentally friendly, digital form.

5

The media want us to think that buying things for ourselves and each other will make us happier. A simple look at the facts shows us this isn't the case, and it seems we have figured that out.

Recent surveys prove that experiences elicit more happiness than buying material things.

Yan Young of online adventure company, best days ever, explains 'Even your most treasured possessions remain separate from you. Experiences become embedded in your memory, they're part of you.'

10

After all, would people rather hear about your new shoes or the time you took a ride in a hot-air balloon over mountains?

Many of our parents didn't have the ability to travel as much as we do, or the freedom to easily change jobs, relocate or start a business like you can in today's world. Therefore, they valued things – jewellery, cars, houses – signs of prosperity and stability. Things they owned were precious, they thought, but things can be lost, stolen or damaged.

15

Most of us have way too much stuff. One survey found that 1 in 7 Americans has a room in their home that they can't get into because it's filled with things they rarely use. And the more things we accumulate, the more miserable we become. Life's like a game of 'Stuff or Nothing?'. Meanwhile, the trend towards 'no ownership' adventures is increasing in experiences that improve life and don't need wrapping.

20

Online companies offer a range of experience gifts at increasingly competitive prices. Looking for a last-minute gift? Goat yoga (part exercise, part petting zoo and 100 per cent adorable), race-car driving, foreign travel, escape room (you're locked in a room and forced to find your way out by solving dozens of puzzles before the timer runs out), even a house-cleaning service (an experience I'll probably gift to myself).

25

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2 hours

You must answer on the question paper.

You will need: Insert (enclosed)

INSTRUCTIONS

- Answer **two** questions in total:
 Question A: answer Question 1.
 Question B: answer **one** question.
- Use a black or dark blue pen.
- Write your name, centre number and candidate number in the boxes at the top of the page.
- Write your answer to each question in the space provided.
- Do **not** use an erasable pen or correction fluid.
- Do **not** write on any bar codes.
- If additional space is needed, you should use the lined pages at the end of this booklet; the question number or numbers must be clearly shown.
- Dictationaries are **not** allowed.

INFORMATION

- The total mark for this paper is 80.
- The number of marks for each question or part question is shown in brackets [].
- The insert contains the reading texts.

This document has **12** pages. Any blank pages are indicated.



Read Text A and Text B in the insert and then answer **Section A, Question 1** on this question paper.

Section A: Directed Writing

Question 1

Imagine you have a friend who is considering whether to buy a gift experience for someone they know, or to choose another type of gift. They have asked for your advice.

Write a letter to your friend offering your advice.

In ur letter u hould:

- evaluate the ideas, opinions and attitudes given in both texts
- explain what your friend needs to consider when deciding on the most appropriate type of gift for this person
- give reasons to support your advice.

Base your letter on what you have read in **both** texts but be careful to use your own words
Address all of the bullet points

Write about 250 to 350 words

Up to 15 marks are available for the content of your answer, and up to 25 marks for the quality of your writing.

This image shows a single sheet of white paper with horizontal blue ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.

[Turn to page 6 for Section B]

Section B: Composition

Answer **one** question from Set ion B.

Write about 350 to 450 words on **one** of the following questions. Answer on this question paper.

Up to 16 marks are available for the content and structure of your answer, and up to 24 marks for the style and accuracy of your writing.

EITHER

Descriptive writing

2 Describe walking or riding along a path or track you have not explored before.

OR

Descriptive writing

3 Write a description with the title, 'Getting busier and busier'.

OR

Narrative writing

4 Write a story that includes the words '... this was like no creature I'd encountered before'...

OR

Narrative writing

5 Write a story with the title, 'The forest'.

[illegible]

[illegible]

[illegible]

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